

I'm pivoting to an advertisement. One that's gotten me excited. I found three full page ads from Nikon in the November 2006 issue of *MacWorld* magazine. I'm going to explore one of them (shown here), and a bit of the whole ad campaign:

stunningnikon.com/joe

stunningnikon.com/donald

stunningnikon.com/timothy

stunningnikon.com/heather

They shoot for photo sites like Flickr.™ They shoot for family photo albums. They shoot because they're passionate about taking pictures. What did they capture with the new 10.2 megapixel Nikon® D80™? See more of the jaw-dropping highlights at stunningnikon.com/dslr

Nikon
At the heart of the image.™

Outline

- **Rhetors:**

Nikon, since they're the ones who made the ad. Nikon wants to sell you their D80 model DSLR camera. Then there's the magazine featuring the ad. It's a good magazine for this

advertisement to be featured in; with both having to do with fancy, more premium technology. (The camera body cost \$1,000 in 2006). And lastly there are the people whose photographs are being featured, and a bit more abstractly, the dog being cute. Their photos are being used to show how good the camera is, even when used by everyday amateur photographers.

- **Exigences:**

The whole idea of this ad is that amateur photographers can get amazing photos from using this camera. “They shoot for family photo albums,” “See more of the jaw-dropping highlights at stunningnikon.com/dslr.” That’s how they’re trying to convince you to buy the camera. In another of the ads appearing in this same November 2006 issue, it says “We gave them the new Nikon D80.” And from a quick search, it’s confirmed Nikon gave away cameras for free to a select group of people to try out:

(<http://www.adweek.com/brand-marketing/picture-perfect-89133/>,
<http://www.dpreview.com/forums/threads/stunningnikon.1994354/>,
<http://www.flickr.com/groups/71858314@N00/>)

It’s naturally very hard for a company to sell an expensive, enthusiast product to amateurs. But this is fascinating, and I think it is a very effective way to get people interested in a product that may normally be too expensive for them.

- **Audiences:**

For this ad, I think it’s mainly targeted at amateur photographers. Those who mainly do it as more of a hobby, it’s not their job, so they wouldn’t be inclined to spend hundreds or thousands of dollars on it. Or those without the skill to properly use other, more expensive models. Those who “shoot for family photo albums.”

But also, I see it being aimed at photography enthusiasts or semi-professional photographers. Those who are more than willing to splurge on a premium option. Here’s a camera that doesn’t need too much skill to take amazing photos.

- **Constraints:**

This ad prioritizes the space for photos. But of the three in the magazine, it’s the most balanced. This one has an effective paragraph, but also attractive photos that still manage to take up most of the space. One weird constraint that’s appeared now that it’s going to be 20 years old in a few months, is that “stunningnikon.com” is not a domain that’s owned by Nikon anymore. So, unless you’ve heard of tools like the Wayback Machine, you’re not going to be able to see the other photos from the campaign. (And even then, it doesn’t work

very well, as the site was made with Adobe Flash)

But aside from those, a big one is that there were a lot of photos taken as part of the campaign. There might've been a lot of great ones to showcase in the full-page magazine ad, but they had to narrow down to just four. Or on the flipside it could've been that these were a stretch to get. But according to the users on the forum page I listed [above](#), they were apparently mostly good.